



TEAM 36

Strategies for Professional Growth

INTERIM REPORT

Team Details

- Nitya Sharma - (23f3003687)
- Vinil Vasukuttan - (23f2004837)
- Ashish Raj - (22f3000982)
- Rasiga. B - (23f2005694)
- Digvijaysinh S Chudasama - (21f2000588)

Compiled By : Nitya Sharma

INTERIM REPORT - NITYA SHARMA

1. Working Professional Details

- **Name:** Mrs. Suchita Sthalekar
- **Role:** Team Manger, Project Manger at DTCS pune
- **Industry:** Healthcare IT / T-Systems
- **Experience:** 22 years

2. Key Discussion Points & Insights

- 1. Productivity vs Being Busy :** The interviewee drew a nuanced distinction between being busy and being productive. While busy weeks often yielded good output, not every task added direct business value. She emphasized the importance of asking — *"Did this task add value to the business?"* — as a key self-check for genuine productivity.
- 2. Quality Over Volume :** Working in a SAFe and Agile environment, her organization prioritizes quality over delivery speed. Story points are tracked, but the real measure is the quality of output. She noted that poor quality leads to rework, ultimately costing more time.
- 3. Daily Routines & Tools :** The day begins with a **standup meeting** — a scrum practice where team members share updates, blockers, and plans. She stressed that **face-to-face collaboration resolves issues faster** than searching through documentation. Calendar review the previous evening helps her stay prepared.
- 4. Multitasking as a Productivity Hack :** Having managed 50–60 people alongside delivery responsibilities, she identified **multitasking and context-switching** as critical skills for career growth — handling people issues, HR processes, stakeholder updates and technical reviews simultaneously.
- 5. Managing Distractions :** Phone notifications and family messages are the primary distractions in a hybrid setup. Her approach: **time-box distractions** — allow a brief break, then return to work. She observed that Gen Z team members use brief social media interactions as a mental refresh, which actually boosts their creativity.
- 6. AI & Future of Work :** She estimates AI currently handles **~25% of her managerial work** — presentations, reports, project tracking. She predicts project management roles will be significantly automated within five years, but **people management, collaboration and communication will remain irreplaceable** human skills.
- 7. Technical Skills vs Soft Skills :** She observed that highly technical individuals often work in silos and struggle to collaborate, which **reduces overall team productivity** even if their individual output is strong. Soft skills — communication, collaboration, personal development — are equally critical.

3. Relevant Quotes

- *"Quality is the top priority for us. Even if someone is taking a bit longer, what was the quality output? That is more important."*
- *"Face-to-face discussions save a lot of time — rather than searching a document, someone sitting with you and giving you the solution is faster."*
- *"Multitasking is one thing that helped me improve my productivity over the years — you have to switch, expand your horizon."*
- *"AI cannot replace humans — people management, collaboration, and communication will continue. That personal touch will always require a human."*
- *"Do what you like. The productivity, quality — everything will follow. Follow your passion and you will reach the top in that field."*

INTERIM REPORT - VINIL VASUKUTTAN

1. Working Professional Details

- **Name:** Ms. Shamily Babu
- **Role:** Business Analyst at Primasoft Technologies
- **Industry:** IT Consulting
- **Experience:** 3

2. Key Discussion Points & Insights

1. **Work Breakdown and Tracking:** A highly effective method for daily productivity is breaking down major tasks into simpler, manageable steps. By physically striking out completed tasks and rolling over unfinished ones to the next day, you maintain a clear, continuous view of your progress
2. **The Necessity of Prioritization Tiers:** Establishing clear goals requires strict prioritization, such as categorizing tasks into P1, P2, and P3 tiers. This ensures the most critical work gets done first, a practical skill the interviewee noted is essential in the workplace but often undeveloped during college years.
3. **Communication as a Non-Negotiable Tool:** For roles that require gathering requirements, proactive communication is an absolute necessity to navigate projects and clear blockers. While developers or testers might be able to work in isolation, continuous collaboration is required to ensure successful product delivery.
4. **Protecting Time with "Focus Hours":** Excessive meetings and planning can consume entire days and hinder actual product delivery. Implementing dedicated "focus hours"—where you intentionally ignore non-urgent messages, emails, and calls—is vital to secure time for focused execution.
5. **Strategic and Smart Use of AI:** AI is a powerful productivity booster for repetitive tasks, such as drafting documentation and fixing grammatical errors. However, human oversight remains crucial for understanding specific client expectations and identifying unique edge cases.
6. **Managing Over-Allocated Resources:** Highly skilled technical workers can paradoxically become productivity bottlenecks if they juggle too many projects without clear prioritization. Enforcing accountability through clear communication and formal agreements is necessary to manage these shared resources and prevent project delays

3. Relevant Quotes

- **The Over-Allocated Developer Anecdote:** *The interviewee shared an anecdote about a highly skilled developer who was spread too thin across multiple projects, resulting in unaddressed bugs and vague status updates during scrum calls. To solve this, the interviewee enforced a rule requiring a direct email confirmation from the product owner whenever they pulled the developer away, officially acknowledging that the original project delivery would be delayed. This accountability measure successfully resolved the delivery problems.*
- **Quote on Delivering Results Over Meetings:** *Emphasizing the need to balance coordination with actual work, the interviewee stated, "Planning is important, but we also need to have a working product at the end of the day". This highlights the core motivation behind using "focus hours" to escape continuous meetings.*
- **Quote on AI Limitations:** *While praising AI's ability to speed up documentation, the interviewee highlighted where the technology falls short: "We cannot rely on AI because we only know what the client expects, right? So as a human, we need to think about it. As a human, we need to, you know, think about edge cases"*

INTERIM REPORT - ASHISH RAJ

1. Working Professional Details

- **Name:** Mr. Sachin Mishra
- **Role:** Manager at a Multinational Corporation, Noida
- **Industry:** Property Insurance / Catastrophe Risk Modeling
- **Experience:** 15+ Years

2. Key Discussion Points & Insights

1. Definition of Productivity : Mishra defined personal productivity as the time spent learning beyond routine tasks. In a typical 8-hour workday, if 6 hours go toward core responsibilities, the remaining **2 hours should be dedicated to learning and skill development.**

2. Measuring Productivity at Work : Productivity is tracked across three activities — processing work tasks, auditing completed work, and communicating with underwriters. Automation tools help employees log daily activities, enabling managers to generate **monthly productivity reports** identifying time spent on core vs non-core tasks.

3. Daily Productivity Strategy : Every morning tasks are assigned to team members who must report back daily on work completed, progress made, and new skills learned. This structured routine builds **accountability and continuous improvement.**

4. Hybrid vs Remote Work : Mishra prefers a **hybrid work model** over fully remote work. While remote work may boost short-term productivity, working from the office enhances learning through peer interaction, mentorship, and team collaboration.

5. Challenges in Productivity : A major challenge is the **lack of transparency in time reporting** — team members are sometimes not fully honest about how long manual tasks take, which affects accurate productivity measurement.

6. AI & Future of Work : Mishra believes AI will significantly transform workplace productivity. Tasks requiring five employees today may need only **two or three with automation**, freeing professionals to focus on higher-value work and continuous skill development.

7. Technical Skills for Productivity : He strongly advised students to build strong technical foundations, particularly in tools like **SQL and Microsoft Excel**, stating that mastering a few essential technologies can greatly enhance both productivity and career growth.

3. Relevant Quotes

- “Personal productivity is the time you spend learning beyond your daily tasks.”
- “If you work eight hours a day and spend six hours on core work, the remaining two hours should be used to learn something new.”
- “Strong technical skills like SQL and Excel help you complete tasks faster and more efficiently.”
- “AI will reduce the number of people required for many tasks, but it will also create opportunities to work on more meaningful projects.”

INTERIM REPORT - RASIGA. B

1. Working Professional Details

- **Name:** Dr. Parvati Sharma
- **Role:** Asst. Professor at Chaudhary Bansi Lal University
- **Industry:** Education/Research
- **Experience:** 8 years

2. Key Discussion Points & Insights

- 1. Productivity vs Being busy :** Productive time involves meaningful work like research and high-impact tasks, while busy periods are filled with routine activities such as emails and messages in an open-door environment. Continuous activity does not always mean real progress.
- 2. Weekly Reflection :** A weekly reflection is carried out to evaluate whether the work contributed to actual progress. This helps distinguish between effort and impact and improves future planning.
- 3. Output Over Deadlines :** Greater emphasis is placed on the quality of output rather than strictly following deadlines. Focusing on meaningful and well-executed work ensures better long-term value compared to completing tasks in a rushed manner just to meet timelines.
- 4. Structured Start :** The day begins with a structured routine of spending the first 30 minutes on emails and messages. This helps in clearing smaller tasks early, reducing interruptions, and allowing more focused time for important work later.
- 5. Time Blocking & Distraction Management :** Time-blocking is used to allocate specific time slots for different tasks, ensuring better organization and efficient use of time. Distractions, especially from mobile phones, are actively minimized to maintain focus, improve concentration, and enhance overall productivity.
- 6. Structured Weekly Workflow & Planning :** Work is organized by assigning different tasks to specific days of the week. Additionally, a short weekly planning session helps prepare for upcoming responsibilities and ensures a smooth workflow.
- 7. Growing Use of AI in Work :** AI is becoming increasingly useful in professional work, especially for tasks such as citations and other academic support activities. It helps reduce manual effort and saves time in handling repetitive tasks. As a result, it is seen as a valuable tool that improves efficiency and supports day-to-day work processes.

3. Relevant Quotes

- “Do not confuse motion with progress — being constantly busy does not mean meaningful work is getting done.”
- “It is important to pause and reflect on whether the work done actually contributed to progress.”
- “Output matters more than deadlines — the quality of work is what truly defines the result.”
- “Planning just three key tasks for the day brings clarity and helps maintain focus.”
- “Managing distractions, especially from mobile phones, is essential to stay productive.”
- “AI is becoming useful for tasks like citations and academic work, helping save time in routine activities.”

INTERIM REPORT - DIGVIJAYSINH S CHUDASAMA

1. Working Professional Details

- **Name:** Mr. Rahul Mahajan
- **Role:** Principal Software Engineering Leader at Infosys (Ex-Microsoft, Ex-Google)
- **Industry:** Software Engineering/ IT Services
- **Experience:** ~20 years

2. Key Discussion Points & Insights

1. Productivity vs Being Busy : Productivity is not just about completing tasks but about delivering **high-quality output with minimal defects**. Completing work quickly but introducing bugs leads to rework and reduces overall productivity. True productivity lies in balancing **speed with quality and impact**.

2. Quality- Driven Productivity Measurement : Productivity varies based on the type of work. In **bug fixing**, it is measured by how quickly issues are resolved without regression. In **new development**, the focus is on **quality, collaboration, and long-term impact** rather than just output volume.

3. Importance of Problem Understanding (360° Approach) : A key habit highlighted was developing a **complete understanding of the problem before coding**. Rahul emphasized following all phases of SDLC — analysis, design, development, and testing — as skipping these steps leads to poor outcomes regardless of technical skills.

4. Agile Practices & Story Clarity : Working in Agile, productivity is tracked through **story points within sprints**. Tasks should be: small and manageable, clearly defined, testable and measurable. Clear **Definition of Ready** and **Definition of Done** are essential to avoid ambiguity and ensure timely completion.

5. Managing Hybrid Work Challenges : Remote work often leads to reduced communication and siloed working. To overcome this, Rahul introduced **virtual collaboration rooms**, where team members could discuss issues in real time. This significantly improved communication and increased productivity by 10–15%.

6. Leadership & Team Productivity : Even highly skilled engineers may struggle if they lack a broader understanding of the system. Rahul emphasized the importance of: Identifying individual strengths, Assigning tasks accordingly, Providing training to bridge skill gaps. Effective leadership ensures that individual strengths contribute positively to overall team productivity.

7. AI & Future of Software Engineering : AI is expected to automate repetitive tasks but will not replace engineers. It can act as a junior developer, but human oversight is required for: Code quality, Decision making, System design. The key to future success is **continuous learning and adaptability**, as technologies evolve over time.

3. Relevant Quotes

- “Productivity means completing your work with quality, not just completing it.”
- “If your code creates bugs, it is not productive — it is creating more work.”
- “Understanding the problem in 360 degrees is more important than just coding.”
- “Clear definition of done is very important, otherwise productivity will go down.”
- “When people work in silos, productivity drops — collaboration improves it.”
- “AI can act like a junior engineer, but someone must review its work.”
- “Technology changes, but the need for skilled engineers will always remain.”